



United States
Attorney's Office
Southern District of Iowa



Two Iowa Healthcare Practitioners Settle Allegations for False Submission of Claims to Federal Healthcare Programs in Telemedicine Scheme



Thursday, January 16, 2025

For Immediate Release

U.S. Attorney's Office, Southern District of Iowa

DES MOINES, Iowa – Two Iowa healthcare practitioners have entered into civil settlements to resolve allegations that they violated the False Claims Act by knowingly causing the submission of false or fraudulent claims to Medicare as part of a telemedicine scheme.

Nurse practitioner Cori Lempiainen has agreed to pay \$150,000 to the United States to resolve allegations that between October 4, 2021 and November 11, 2022 she billed Medicare for over 650 claims for office visits and medical discussions she did not provide, and signed over 2,700 orders for medically unnecessary durable medical equipment, such as orthotic braces.

Paul Baumert, M.D., has agreed to pay \$14,325.96 to the United States to resolve allegations that between May 16, 2022 and August 26, 2022 he billed Medicare for over 200 claims for office visits and medical discussions that he did not provide, and signed over 180 orders for medically unnecessary durable medical equipment, such as orthotic braces.

Both practitioners participated in a telemedicine scheme in which they placed orders for braces based on listening to recorded cold calls to Medicare beneficiaries asking about common aches and pains. Neither Lempiainen nor Baumert had any contact with the Medicare beneficiaries for whom they signed orders or submitted claims, and beneficiaries complained of receiving braces they did not want or use.

"Telemedicine schemes like these rely on the willing participation of healthcare providers to defraud the Medicare program by signing orders for expensive and unnecessary medical braces and other equipment," said Richard D. Westphal, U.S. Attorney for the Southern District of Iowa. "Our office will continue to aggressively pursue healthcare fraud in all forms."

The cases were investigated by the United States Department of Health and Human Services, Office of Inspector General and handled by Assistant U.S. Attorney Amy C. Licht of the Southern District of Iowa and Assistant U.S. Attorney Brian J. Keogh of the Northern District of Iowa.

Tips and complaints from all sources about potential fraud, waste, abuse, and mismanagement can be reported to the Department of Health and Human Services at 800-HHS-TIPS (800-447-8477).

The claims resolved by the settlement are allegations only and there has been no determination of liability.

Links to the settlement agreements are available below.

[Baumert Final Settlement](#)

[Lempiainen Final Settlement](#)

Contact

MacKenzie Tubbs
Public Information Officer
515-473-9300
USAIAS.PAO@usdoj.gov

Updated January 16, 2025

Topic

HEALTHCARE FRAUD

Components

[USAO - Iowa, Northern](#) | [USAO - Iowa, Southern](#)

Related Content

PRESS RELEASE

Southern District of Iowa Announces Cases Related to the 2026 National Health Care Fraud Takedown

DES MOINES, Iowa – The United States Attorney's Office for the Southern District of Iowa announced a civil complaint and a civil settlement, as part of the Department of Justice's...

June 29, 2026

PRESS RELEASE

Marshalltown Woman Pleads Guilty to Charges Related to Drug Diversion

DES MOINES, Iowa – A Marshalltown woman pleaded guilty yesterday to diverting controlled substances for her own use and falsely noting the administration of a controlled substance in a patient...

March 14, 2025

PRESS RELEASE

Davenport Chiropractor Charged with False Statements, Bank Fraud, and Money Laundering for PPP Loan and Mortgage Fraud Schemes

DAVENPORT, IA – A Davenport man made his initial appearance today in federal court in Davenport on false statements to a financial institution, bank fraud, and money laundering charges.

March 14, 2023



Southern District of Iowa

Main Office

